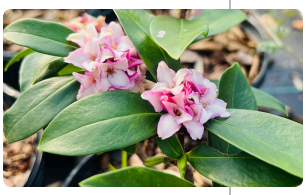
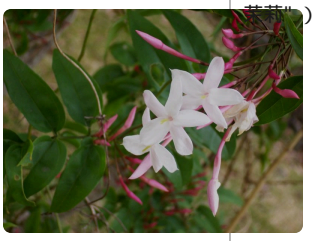
Berkeley 香花名录 · Fragrant Flower Reference for Berkeley, CA

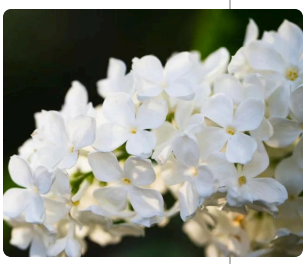
22 scented plants with bilingual (Chinese–English) names. Sorted by **bloom start (December → September)** for easy year-round reference.

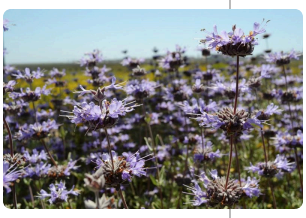
- **Climate background**: Central Berkeley flats (near University Ave / Trader Joe's; not the Berkeley Hills) ≈ USDA 10a on the 2023 map, with 10b pockets nearby; the 2012 map showed 10a here. Warm-summer Mediterranean (Köppen Csb) with strong marine influence: cooler, foggier summers than the hills (frequent afternoon marine layer that can persist into evening), mild winters, rare frost, ~22–25" annual rain.
- **Scent rating**: ★–★★★★★ (intensity detectable at arm's length; generally reduced on foggy days).

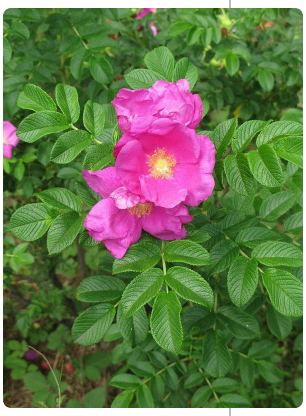
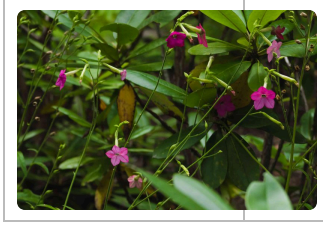
English name	Chinese name	Berkeley cultivation notes	Scent notes	Bloom period (scent months)	Asian cultural notes
Wintersweet (Chimonanthus praecox) 	蜡梅	Easy to grow: full sun to partial shade, excellent drainage (does not tolerate standing water around the roots), drought-tolerant once established; yellow-flowered types are far more fragrant than white-flowered ones[1]	★★★★ Cold fragrance that intensifies as temperatures drop; the yellow types ('Aureus'/'苏雨仙' lineage) are intense, white-flowered types are very faint	Dec–Feb	The twelfth-month (腊月) flower deity of the traditional "Flower Calendar" (花历); long prized in Chinese literati culture for its "cold fragrance" (冷香) as a symbol of lofty, unworldly character; sometimes grouped with other fragrant classics
Wallflower (Cheiranthus cheiri, now Erysimum × cheiri) 	桂竹香[2]	Easy to grow: cool-season crop, grown as a biennial (short-lived perennial); full sun, does not tolerate standing water (well-drained soil); frequent deadheading prolongs the bloom	★★★★ Spicy-sweet Brassicaceae scent - the old-fashioned "wall scent" (hence the English name wallflower)	Dec–Mar	In the Chinese tradition, in fine gardens by the Tang dynasty (recorded in ancient materia medica (《本草》) texts and in Tang poetry) - on that lineage, one of the oldest winter-fragrance flowers in the Chinese garden context
White Champaca (Magnolia × alba) 	白兰	Tender subtropical hybrid: cold-sensitive and prefers warmer, more protected microclimates. In the cooler, foggier central Berkeley flats, in-ground flowering is unreliable and pot + winter protection is safer; established trees do flower well in warmer Bay Area spots (e.g. Berkeley Hills, SF Botanical Garden, Stanford)	★★★★★ The reference scent of the street flower vendors and yulan tea; most intense in the cool morning	Dec–Mar (Bay Area); multiple flushes in warm regions	Core of Lingnan (South China) and old-Shanghai folk custom: flowers pinned in the hair, street flower carriers (花婆, "flower aunties"), yulan (白兰) tea; the Cantonese name "pak lan" is the Cantonese reading of 白兰, and the flower is a staple of Lingnan nostalgia imagery (the classic song 白兰花, literature); close relative Yellow Champaca (黄缅 桂) (yellow champaca, *Magnolia champaca*) is an offering flower in South Asian Hindu and Buddhist worship

English name	Chinese name	Berkeley cultivation notes	Scent notes	Bloom period (scent months)	Asian cultural notes
Banana Shrub (Michelia figo, syn. Magnolia figo) 	含笑	Extremely easy: cold- and drought-tolerant, full sun to partial shade, almost maintenance-free	★★★–★★★★ Banana-sweet fragrance, strongest in the morning and when cool	Primarily spring (Apr–Jun), with possible extension into summer/fall in mild Bay Area climates	"Manjushri's smile" from the Vimalakirti Sutra; the idiom "smile in the netherworld" derives from the flower; common subject in literati painting
Winter Daphne (Daphne odora) 	瑞香	Very easy to grow (the least demanding of the *Daphne* genus): drainage is a matter of life and death (does not tolerate standing water around the roots), summer-dry, full sun to partial shade; performs even better in the Bay Area than in the East	★★★★★ One of the most intense woody-plant scents of winter and spring	Jan–Mar (earlier in the Bay Area than in the East)	the name 瑞香 means "fragrance of auspicious omen" (花中祥瑞 "auspicious omen among flowers"); *Daphne* is planted in the 紫竹林 (Purple Bamboo Grove) on Mt. Putuo, a Guanyin/Avalokiteshvara pilgrimage site
Paperwhite Narcissus (Narcissus papyraceus / tazetta group) 	洋水仙 (纸白型) [3]	Primarily an indoor forcing bulb: set on pebbles/rocks with water just touching the base, blooms in 4–6 weeks; discard after bloom (standard practice). Can also be planted outdoors in fall in mild Bay Area gardens where it may naturalize, but the classic use is the temporary indoor display	★★★★ Strong fragrance typical of the tazetta group (most other narcissus are scentless or weakly scented)	Feb–Mar	No traditional Asian cultural background for this Western tazetta form; the classic Chinese New Year narcissus is N. tazetta var. chinensis — do not confuse the two
Hyacinth (Hyacinthus orientalis) 	风信子	Primarily an indoor forcing bulb (pre-chilled or chilled, then bloomed in soil or water; often discarded after). It also grows well in Berkeley: plant outdoors in fall (15 cm deep, good drainage) — the dry summer dormancy our climate provides is exactly what it needs (wet summers are what kills it) — and it often persists, even naturalizing, as a garden bulb; local nurseries (e.g. Berkeley Horticultural Nursery) stock it as a standard spring bulb. The classic use, though, is temporary indoor forcing	★★★★★ The strongest of the early-spring scents — a single vase fills a room	Feb–Apr (indoor forcing); Mar–Apr (outdoors)	A Middle Eastern / Mediterranean plant with no traditional place in Asian flower culture; it entered modern Asian life on the strength of its scent alone (cut flowers, indoor fragrance)

English name	Chinese name	Berkeley cultivation notes	Scent notes	Bloom period (scent months)	Asian cultural notes
'Brandywine' Crabapple (Malus 'Branzam' / Brandywine®) 	海棠（'Brandywine'）[4]	Easy to grow: small tree, full sun, water while young, drought-tolerant once established; watch for scab (moderate resistance) and rust (poorer resistance)	★★★★ Double rose-pink flowers, strongly scented; fruit rather bitter	Mar–Apr (flowers)	Crabapples (海棠) are a classic spring symbol in Chinese garden culture, 'Brandywine' is a double-pink flowering crab bred by Simpson Nursery in the 1970s–80s, with large-ish fruit (~1") that is bitter / high in tannin, and no Asian pedigree — its name is unrelated to the famous Brandywine tomato
Mexican Orange Blossom (Choisya ternata) 	三叶橙花	Extremely easy: native to Mexico, zero maintenance, drought-tolerant, full sun to part shade	★★★ Orange-blossom (neroli-type) scent, moderate	Mar–Apr (occasional late-summer / fall rebloom)	A North American native with no Asian cultural background; it was adopted into Asian gardens on the strength of its orange-blossom scent
Pink Jasmine (Jasminum polyanthum) 	多花素馨（花市称"粉茉莉/多花茉莉"）[5]	Extremely easy: vigorous evergreen climber, loves Mediterranean climate, full sun, drought-tolerant once established; needs a support to climb	★★★★★ The most fragrant of the "jasmines"; pink buds open white, especially intense on summer nights	Mar–Oct (heaviest in spring)	Native to Southwest China (Yunnan / Guizhou), a close relative of the jasmines used for jasmine tea; no deep cultural lore of its own
Chinese Wisteria (Wisteria sinensis) 	紫藤	Growable: Japanese wisteria (W. floribunda) is more fragrant but does poorly in the fog belt, so this species is the compromise; the plant gets huge and needs steel-frame support; water while young, drought-tolerant once established; escaped / naturalized plants are reported along the coast — keep it off property lines	★★★ Mild sweet scent, far weaker than Japanese wisteria (W. floribunda)	Apr–May (flowers before or with the leaves)	A staple of poetry, calligraphy and painting since the Tang / Song eras; Japan has wisteria festivals (藤花祭, fuji); Korea regards wisteria as a symbol of longevity / a happy marriage

English name	Chinese name	Berkeley cultivation notes	Scent notes	Bloom period (scent months)	Asian cultural notes
Perfumed Currant (Ribes odoratum) 	香醋栗 (香水醋栗)	Growable: native to central North America (Minnesota to Texas, not the Pacific coast), cool-climate lover, full sun to part shade, drought-tolerant once established. Note: this white-flowered eastern form is a cold-climate shrub (USDA 3–4) and is one of the harder plants in the table for the Bay Area — it survives Berkeley winters but needs consistent moisture and summer protection from dry heat/fog-free heat (a pot, a cool moist corner, or summer irrigation); the yellow-flowered California-native *R. aureum* (var. *gracillimum*) is the form that thrives here if scent can be traded for reliability.	★★★★★ Jasmine + orange-blossom / clove-type floral scent, one of the most fragrant berry shrubs	May–Jun	A central North American native with no Asian cultural background; a "newcomer" to Asian gardens
Lilac, white (Syringa vulgaris white cultivars; more reliable on the coast: Syringa reticulata, Japanese tree lilac) 	白丁香[6]	Moderate: S. vulgaris survives in the Bay Area but is a marginal fit (it prefers the colder, wetter Eastern climate) — full sun + good drainage + a little summer water; the low-maintenance pick is S. reticulata, which shrugs off drought and fog	★★★★ White cultivars are usually harder-hitting than the purple ones (a common grower observation — scent varies by cultivar, so check the specific variety)	May–Jun	The "lilac knot" (丁香结) — unopened buds clustered like a knot: Li Shangyin's " 芭蕉不展丁香结" ("the banana leaf stays furled, the lilac knots unloosed") is the classic image of pent-up sorrow in Chinese poetry (mostly the purple lilac); in Japan the lilac (ハシドイ, hashidoi) is a familiar early-spring bloom
Gardenia (Gardenia jasminoides) 	栀子花	The hardest on the easy-to-grow list: acidic soil (pH<6), consistent moisture, iron supplements, frost protection; the fog belt actually lends a little humidity; the most reliable plan is a pot + moving inside for winter	★★★★★ White flowers everywhere, a house full of scent; even a single stem fills a room	May–Sep (peaks late summer in the Bay Area)	• Fruit = the traditional natural yellow dye (栀子黄, gardenia yellow) and a Chinese medicine (栀子, shanzhizi) • Pop culture: 《栀子花开》("Gardenia Blooms") = the symbol of youth / summer • Japan: くちなし carries a melancholy image (the cemetery-planting tradition)

English name	Chinese name	Berkeley cultivation notes	Scent notes	Bloom period (scent months)	Asian cultural notes
Cleveland Sage (Salvia clevelandii) 	克利夫兰鼠尾草	Extremely easy to grow: a Southern California native (chaparral and coastal sage scrub); full sun, good drainage, so drought-tolerant that it survives on rainfall alone once established	★★★★ One of the most intensely fragrant of all salvias: a passing breeze sets the whole clump perfuming the air, and rubbing the leaves releases a sharp, strong sage scent	May–Sep (in the Bay Area this includes a late-fall rebloom; a Bay Area gardener reports Cleveland sage blooming from May through Nov)	Native to California, with no known Asian cultural background; it can be viewed as the Western version of the "fragrant salvias" (芳香 鼠尾草) — its kitchen-garden role is the same as the one 藿香 (huòxiāng, wrinkled giant hyssop, *Agastache rugosa*) and 紫苏 (perilla, shiso in Japan) fill in the East Asian tradition
California Mock Orange (Philadelphus lewisii) 	山梅花（刘易斯山梅花）	Easy to grow: native to the Pacific Northwest (range extends into the Sierra Nevada of central California); cold-hardy (USDA zone 4) and vigorous; full sun; moderate summer water	★★★★ Heavy "orange blossom/mock orange" scent during bloom; sweet, heady, citrus-blossom-like, some sources note a hint of pineapple	May–Jun (late spring to early summer)	No Asian cultural background: the specific name (lewisii) commemorates Meriwether Lewis of the Lewis and Clark expedition; "山梅花" (mountain plum-blossom) is the established Chinese name for the genus Philadelphus, which can be mistaken for a Chinese-origin plant
Damask Rose (Rosa × damascena) 	大马士革玫瑰（大马士[illegible]）	Moderate difficulty: in the fog belt, pick **the sunniest, driest, best-drained** spot; in cool, wet springs and autumns, watch for downy mildew and powdery mildew; fog clearly weakens scent production [7]	★★★★★ The "rose" scent standard: rose otto (attar) and rose dew (rose water) are both distilled from it; cool summers under fog cut the output	May–Jun (single season)	National flower of Iran; Saudi Taif rose culture (rose-water distillation and related practices) registered on UNESCO's intangible cultural heritage list in December 2024; in India the base of gulab (rose water / rose jam) — desserts like gulab jamun, and a scent woven through religious practice; the reference standard behind China's edible-rose traditions: rose cake (玫瑰饼), rose mooncake (玫瑰月饼), rose dew wine (玫瑰露酒)

English name	Chinese name	Berkeley cultivation notes	Scent notes	Bloom period (scent months)	Asian cultural notes
Rugosa Rose (Rosa rugosa, incl. Pingyin rose R. rugosa var. platyphylla) 	突瓣蔷薇/海滨蔷薇（平阴玫瑰系）[8]	Easy to grow: an East Asian coastal sand-dune rose, naturalized on California coasts; shrugs off drought, salt and wind, no irrigation once established; spreads by suckering runners, so keep the boundaries in check	★★★ Moderate (the wide-leaf Pingyin type is more fragrant and more on the culinary side); far weaker than Damask	Jun–Aug (can rebloom)	Pingyin rose (Shandong) is China's classic edible rose: 玫瑰酱 (rose jam) / 玫瑰饼 (rose cakes) / 玫瑰露 (rose dew); the rugosa lineage is the main bloodline of China's edible roses
Lavender (Lavandula angustifolia, 'Hidcote'/'Sentia'/'Dunvegan') 	薰衣草	Easy to grow: true lavender is fully at home in the Bay Area; full sun + excellently drained dry soil, cut off watering once established; the cool fog belt is fine, but avoid waterlogging	★★★★★ The whole plant is fragrant in all four seasons, most intense during the bloom	Jun-Aug (cultivars staggered)	A symbol of Western romance / Provence, with no traditional role in Asia; it entered modern life through cut flowers and aromatherapy
Star Jasmine (Trachelospermum jasminoides) 	络石（花市称" 风车茉莉" ，实非茉莉属）	Easy to grow: an evergreen twining vine that needs a support (trellis, fence, or arbor); drought-tolerant once established; full sun to part shade	★★★★ Heavy, sweet, jasmine-like scent, strongest on warm evenings; may re-bloom and re-scent in mild Bay Area winters	Jul–Sep (occasional winter re-bloom in the Bay Area)	Trachelospermum vine is a traditional Chinese medicine (络石藤, luoshiteng, used to "dispel wind, unblock collaterals" (祛风通络)); the Chinese Pharmacopoeia in fact cites T. jasminoides as the source of luoshiteng. " 风车茉莉" (pinwheel jasmine) is a purely commercial nursery name; the species has no flower-culture lore
Flowering Tobacco (Nicotiana alata) 	花烟草	Easy to grow: a summer-sown annual that often self-seeds into next year's plants; loves heat and sun, drought-tolerant; the only "night-scent" workhorse in the whole table	★★★★★ Opens after sunset at full blast — the ceiling of a summer garden's scent	Jul–first frost (scent concentrated at night)	A New World plant (the genus Nicotiana is native to North and South America), no Asian tradition

English name	Chinese name	Berkeley cultivation notes	Scent notes	Bloom period (scent months)	Asian cultural notes
Sweet Osmanthus (Osmanthus fragrans) 	桂花	Grows well but at a discount: hardy and thrives in the Bay Area, but the heavy fog and not-hot-enough summers mean fewer flowers and a blunted scent; plant in the sunniest, warmest corner possible; repeat-flowering types (佛顶珠 Fodingzhu / 四季桂 Sijigui) bloom more reliably here than 金桂 Jingui[7]	★★★★★ The benchmark of autumn scent (still the strongest autumn fragrance in the fog belt, discount applied)	Sept–Oct (Bay Area; Sept–Nov farther east or inland)	#1 in the table for cultural weight: the flower most tied to the Mid-Autumn Festival (桂花月饼 osmanthus mooncakes); 折桂 "picking osmanthus in the moon palace" = the millennial metaphor for passing the imperial exams (科举及第); osmanthus wine/cakes/tea; written through by Li Bai (李白), Lu You (陆游) and poets of every age since; in Japan one of the three great aromatic trees (三大香木), with daphne and gardenia; the same autumn/moon lineage on the Korean Peninsula (Chuseok □□)

脚注 · Footnotes

[1] **Wintersweet — plant the yellow-flowered types**: white-flowered chimonanthus is generally faint; for real scent, grow the yellow-green-flowered types ('Aureus', 'Aureospiculata' / 苏雨仙 "Su Yuxian").

[2] **Wallflower 桂竹香** is the standard Chinese name for *Cheiranthus cheiri* (Brassicaceae, genus *Cheiranthus*) — unrelated to osmanthus 桂花 or bamboo 竹; the name is just an inherited old term. The English plant name cheiranth (from the genus name) likewise shares the same Greek root.

[3] **Paperwhite vs Chinese narcissus**: paperwhite belongs to the Western *tazetta* hybrid line; the traditional Chinese New Year flower is the Chinese narcissus (*N. tazetta* var. *chinensis*). Same genus, entirely different cultural systems.

[4] **海棠 "haitang" vs 'Brandywine'**: 海棠 in Chinese is a broad cultural term covering flowering crabapples/quince (贴梗 / 垂丝 / 西府 / 日本海棠); 'Brandywine' (botanical name *Malus* 'Branzam') is a double-petaled pink-flowering crabapple bred by Simpson Nursery in Indiana in the 1970s–80s, fruit ~1 inch, rather bitter. The name is a common place name, unrelated to the famous 19th-century Brandywine tomato (named for Brandywine Creek on the PA/DE border), and no kin to Chinese 海棠.

[5] **多花素馨 is not "true jasmine"**: jasmine tea is made mainly from *Jasminum sambac* (Arabian jasmine / 虎丘茉莉 Huqiu jasmine); *J. polyanthum* is a hardy vine native to southwestern China, sold as "粉茉莉/云南茉莉" (pink jasmine / Yunnan jasmine), with a stronger, more assertive scent.

[6] **The name "白丁香" (white lilac) is ambiguous**: Chinese "白丁香" usually means white-flowered cultivars of common lilac (*S. vulgaris*); but on the coast / in the Bay Area, the fragrant lilac *S. reticulata* (white, drought- and fog-tolerant) is the more dependable choice. Buy by botanical name: *S. vulgaris* = moderate difficulty, *S. reticulata* = easy.

[7] **The fog-belt penalty clause**: "dry-heat heavy-scent" plants like Damask rose and sweet osmanthus 桂花 all get their scent discounted in Berkeley's fog — this is not a growing-practice issue, it is a climate ceiling. For full-strength scent, choose inland hot valley floors (inland East Bay south of Oakland's east side, the Foothills) or accept pot culture.

[8] **The 平阴玫瑰 (Pingyin rose) line**: commercial "平阴玫瑰" = the broad-leaved variety of *Rosa rugosa* (var. *platyphylla*), the workhorse of northern China's edible roses (rose jam 玫瑰酱 / rose cakes 玫瑰饼); in the Bay Area grow it like an ordinary *R. rugosa* — its scent is pleasant but far weaker than Damask rose (the reference standard for rose perfumes and edible roses), matching the row's ★★★ rating.

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- Wintersweet: *File:Chimonanthus praecox, Morris Arboretum 02.jpg* (Shuvaev, CC.
- Wallflower: *File:Erysimum cheiri gold garden flowers.jpg* (Jina Lee, CC BY-SA)
- White Champaca: *File:White champak flower.jpg* (SKsiddhartthan)
- Banana Shrub: *File:Michelia figo flower.JPG* (Midori, CC BY-SA)
- Winter Daphne: open web (Daphne odora in bloom)
- Paperwhite: *File:Narcissus papyraceus 'Paper-White Narcissus' (Amaryllidaceae) flowers HDR.jpg* (Magnus Manske)
- Hyacinth: open web (Hyacinthus orientalis in bloom)
- 'Brandywine' Crabapple: general double pink Malus blossom (proxy; specific cultivar photo scarce)
- Mexican Orange: *File:Choisya Inflorescence FR 2013.jpg* (JLPC, CC BY-SA)
- Pink Jasmine: *File:Jasminum polyanthum flowers.JPG* (B.navez)
- Chinese Wisteria: open web (Wisteria sinensis)
- Perfumed Currant: Dave's Garden member photo (re-hosted via Pinterest), cream/white-flowered form of clove currant. Note: standard botanical descriptions (FNA, MOBOT, RHS) list flowers as yellow; this photo is used per preference for the white/cream form. *R. odoratum* = *R. aureum* var. villosum.
- Lilac (white): open web (Syringa vulgaris white form)
- Gardenia: *File:Gardenia jasminoides flower.jpg* (Md Arif bd)
- Cleveland Sage: open web (Salvia clevelandii in bloom, lavender spikes)
- California Mock Orange: *File:Philadelphus lewisii (7283693140).jpg*
- Damask Rose: open web (Rosa × damascena)
- Rugosa Rose: open web (Rosa rugosa)
- Lavender: open web (Lavandula angustifolia)
- Star Jasmine: open web (Trachelospermum jasminoides)
- Flowering Tobacco: open web (Nicotiana alata)
- Sweet Osmanthus: open web (Osmanthus fragrans)